

Killer Rigs

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Gaming Mice and Keyboards



A frantic call from a friend launches the Agent on a new quest. Can he find the ideal gaming kit for his friend?

Agent 001

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I had just finished a marathon session of *Dead Space 3* and was about to settle in for the night, day actually, and that was when I got the call, shattering my visions of dismembered necromorphs. It was from a friend and he was frantic, he wanted to get a gift for his nephew he said, it was a gaming kit that he had in mind and the plethora of options that he had to choose from had driven him up the wall.

There was something wrong here. My antennae were tingling but it took my sleep-deprived mind two whole minutes to put its mental finger on the issue. He was lying! I mean, I do love my nephews and all that but I don't think even I would get that frantic over getting them a gift. Something was wrong and I had to find out what. I let my friend drone on in the background, muttering a suitably nonsensical word of consolation every now and then as I tried to piece the puzzle together.

Now what did I know about my friend? He had recently suffered the loss of a dear friend, a penguin ("knowing wink"), but that didn't seem related. Ah yes, a recently acquired girlfriend. Hmm, how does that help? Valentine's day of course; and she must be having a dearly beloved sibling or nephew! When it comes to matters of the heart, let no one say that Agent 001 failed his friend(s). I quickly cut my friend's pitiful bleating short with a brusque, "Shut up. I'll be there in 20. Meet me at the station" – strapped on a fresh pair of dungarees, polished my spectacles, grabbed my cap, and set off for the rendezvous.

As I was travelling, I thought about the options available. Being a gift for a kid, it was probably best to have a rugged keyboard, especially if this "nephew" was anything like the little terrors I knew. A mechanical keyboard would be best, but preferably something cheap, as a kid wouldn't appreciate the beauty of a true mechanical keyboard, and he'd probably lose all those detachable keys anyway. Considering this, the TVS Gold mechanical keyboard would be the ideal option; a bit ungainly and maybe a bit too noisy, but it had the two distinct advantages of being a mechanical keyboard without easily detachable keys, and light on the pocket at the same time. That, coupled with the Logitech G400 mouse, the successor to the now legendary MX518, would be the perfect combo for any up and coming gamer on a budget. At about ₹1,500 for the keyboard and ₹1,700 for the mouse, they would be a real steal. The GK105 combo from Logitech, at ₹1,800 would also be a pretty good deal if he was on a budget. This bundle was comparable to the Cyclosa from Razer but the more accessible

DPI switch on the Logitech mouse tipped the balance in the GK105's favour.

The train pulled into the station and as the surge of the exiting crowd "gracefully" deposited me onto the platform, I looked around for my friend. Finally spotting him on a bench, the picture of pure and abject dejection, I grabbed him by the arm and unceremoniously flung him into a nearby cab, hollering a quick, "Lamington road", at the driver. My friend's expression during this whole event moved from dejection to surprise, momentary fear to one of pure relief and then to doe-eyed gratitude.

Bracing myself for the expected outpouring of gratitude, and also wanting to avoid it, I quickly bombarded my friend with questions on this alleged nephew of his. As it turned out, I was wrong about only one thing. This wasn't just a kid we were talking about. This was a discerning young lad who knew his Corsairs from his Cooler Masters and wouldn't be swayed by the mere cosmetic appeal of a device. From what I could make out, he was an avid gamer and an FPS fanatic with a Steam library that would put our very own Big Daddy's collection to shame. For such a person nothing short of the ROCCAT Kone or Cyborg R.A.T. 5 would do, but finding them would be quite a task. The TVS Gold would still be a pretty good choice but probably something with a bit more flair would be in order. My friend however insisted that he had a budget of only ₹5-7k though, so unfortunately, most mechanical keyboards were out



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